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Emily's Post-Apocalyptic Book of Zombie Etiquette

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Emily's Post-Apocalyptic Book of Zombie Etiquette

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A play in ten minutes

By Lauren Hance
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EMILY'S POST-APOCALYPTIC BOOK FOR ZOMBIE ETIQUETTE

SYNOPSIS

Years after the break out o HN666N7 most humans have become zombies. In efforts to bring back the decorum of a more civilized society Emily has taken on the task of writing a new and revised version of the classic book Etiquette. Will the zombies take her advice or will natural instinct take over?

CAST OF CHARACTERS

EMILY, A Zombie. Her physical body resembles that of a zombie, but her dress and general demeanor is clean, polished, and civilized.
ZOMBIE WOMAN 1
ZOMBIE WOMAN 2
ZOMBIE GINA
ZOMBIE CHUCK
ZOMBIE BAR MAN
ZOMBIE BAR WOMAN
ZOMBIE MAN
ZOMBIE WOMAN
ZOMBIE HOSTESS
HUMAN
ZOMBIE GUESTS 1-3
ZOMBIE GIRL
ZOMBIE MOM
ZOMBIE DAD
BILL

SETTING

A Post-Apocalyptic world after the outbreak of the H666N7 virus that turned most humans into zombies. This world is now run by zombies and they are the norm. They are on their way to becoming a civilized society.

PRODUCTION NOTES

The Zombies should move at a zombie like pace and with some kind of limp/lean/ailment(s) as if they have been injured in some capacity. At times they can speed up their pace, but their injuries should still be evident. Most of the time they are fighting their injury in the effort to become more civilized.

Most of the time, the zombies speak with a normal voice, not much grunting, growling or hissing, but it is acceptable to add these sounds in as you see fit, or when the script dictates.

Lines that may be altered per the performer's preference:
Zombie Gina raids an H&M, another store may be used.
Zombie Bar Man's pick-up line may be swapped for another bad pick up line.

EMILY, a zombie, walks center stage. She is holding a large book, titled Emily's Post-Apocalyptic Book for Zombie Etiquette. Her body is zombie like, yet her dress and general appearance is clean and civilized. She opens her book and begins to read aloud, addressing the audience.

EMILY

Arrgghh...

EMILY coughs and clears her throat, then when she finally speaks, she speaks with clarity and decorum.

Dear Zombie Reader. The world we live in has changed so much since the breakout of H666N7. Some may say we are a less civilized society, yet I beg to differ. I believe with the correct guidance and a little effort, we can regain the general concern for others we once had. By the end of this book you will have a new appreciation of the values and manners of previous generations while being able to promote the best practices of today's Zombie society. Being respectful and honest is more important than knowing which fork to use, or even knowing that you should use a fork. Because above all, manners are a general awareness of others. I hope that this book will become a trusted companion and guide wherever your journey takes you. Sincerely Yours, Emily.

EMILY turns the page and crosses away from center.

Chapter 1- The Good Zombie Conversationalist. It is well advised to learn, at minimum, a few words. We all have a tendency towards aggression, but by learning some simple phrases your communication with others will soar and you will find yourself more relaxed and easy going.

Scene shifts to two ZOMBIE WOMEN. ZOMBIE WOMAN 1 speaks with clarity. ZOMBIE WOMAN 2, grunts through the scene.

ZOMBIE WOMAN 1

Grrreeetta. Good to see you.

ZOMBIE WOMAN 2

(Becoming aggressive) Grraahhhrraahhhggg!!!-

ZOMBIE WOMAN

Hard day?

ZOMBIE WOMAN 2

(*More aggressive*) Gggrrrahhhaafffaaa!!!-

ZOMBIE WOMAN 1

I've had days like that myself. Just the other week I wanted to rip the face off my mother-in-law, but I had to remind myself, it's just a phase. So, remember Grrreeetta, it's just a phase.

ZOMBIE WOMAN 2

(*Yelling*) My name isn't Grrreeetta! Arrrgghhhh!!! It's Maaaarrrr- Maaarrr- Mary!

ZOMBIE WOMAN 1

I am so sorry. Mary! Of course! Here I've been calling you Grrreeetta for months, my mistake. I know a really great speech therapist. Only if you're interested.

Scene shifts to EMILY.

EMILY

Chapter 4- Zombie Image and Grooming. While the world we live in, may at times, appear chaotic and run down, it does not mean we must reflect this. Caring how you look is one of the keys to developing good personal relationships. Try your best to not become lax about your appearance or personal hygiene, remnants of stale brains and flesh can become quite a turn off. Taking care of yourself, lets others know you care for and respect them.

Scene shifts to ZOMBIE GINA and ZOMBIE CHUCK.

ZOMBIE GINA

Chuck! Is that you?

ZOMBIE CHUCK

Gina? Good to see you!

ZOMBIE GINA

I almost didn't recognize you, Chuck. How the heck are ya?

ZOMBIE CHUCK

Pretty good, pretty good. Hey, you're lookin' pretty good.

ZOMBIE GINA

Oh, yea, I raided an H&M. Found a new jacket, this sequin top, some leather pants.

ZOMBIE CHUCK

Well it's done wonders for you, really.

ZOMBIE GINA

I was a little sentimental about the sun dress. It was what I was wearing when the pandemic set in. But years of brains, and blood and all that, it just started to have a distinct aroma, and it had to go.

ZOMBIE CHUCK

Well good for you.

ZOMBIE GINA

I've gotta run. It's been great to see you.

ZOMBIE GINA extends her hand to shake ZOMBIE CHUCK'S hand, a moment of hesitation- he does not have an arm.

EMILY

Please note, shaking hands used to be a common and expected courtesy, but in today's world this can become a sensitive subject. A nod of the head is perfectly acceptable.

ZOMBIE CHUCK

Oh, I, uh.... I lost my arm just the other week.

ZOMBIE GINA

I'm so sorry.

ZOMBIE CHUCK

I was chasing a live one. He had an ax. It got a little ugly. Everything's fine, but... (*becoming emotional*) well.... I'm glad you're doing well.

Scene shifts to EMILY.

EMILY

Chapter 7- Zombie Dating. Once upon a time, males were chivalrous; females were demure and coy. He would ask her out and she would graciously accept or decline. But in today's world dating can be a daunting and confusing experience.

Scene shifts to ZOMBIE BAR MAN and ZOMBIE BAR WOMAN 1, in a bar.

ZOMBIE BAR MAN

If I had a nickel for every time I saw someone as beautiful as you, I'd have five cents.

ZOMBIE BAR WOMAN

Arrrrgggghhhhh!!!

ZOMBIE BAR WOMAN 1 attacks ZOMBIE BAR MAN 1, and basically eats him. Scene shifts to EMILY.

EMILY

Bad pick up lines are still uncouth and can result in your demise. Aggression can be tricky, as it does not always mean the other party wants to eat you. It can also be an indication of interest. It is best to politely remove yourself from the situation, and try again later when a clear answer can be determined.

Scene shifts, ZOMBIE WOMAN is holding a human leg and chewing on it. ZOMBIE MAN approaches.

ZOMBIE MAN

I just wanted to say, the way you took down that human back there, it was just- Wow! You really know how to make a man's heart stop. Literally and figuratively.

ZOMBIE WOMAN

Argghhhh!

ZOMBIE MAN

What I mean is- I was just wondering, if maybe sometime, you know, if you're not too busy, if you would like to wander the streets with me?

ZOMBIE WOMAN

Arrgh?

ZOMBIE MAN

We could take a stroll down Main Street, swing by the park. That kind of thing. Maybe even pass by the human refuge and grab a bite to eat?

ZOMBIE WOMAN

Agghhhhaaaa!!!

ZOMBIE MAN

Or not. I mean if you prefer to chase food, we can absolutely do that.

ZOMBIE WOMAN

Arrrgggghhhhhh!!!!

ZOMBIE MAN

Is that a yes or a no?

ZOMBIE WOMAN

AARRRGGGHHHHH!!!!-

ZOMBIE MAN

You know, I think I've caught you at a bad time.

ZOMBIE WOMAN

ARRRHHHHH!!!-

ZOMBIE MAN

I'm gonna let you finish your dinner there-

ZOMBIE WOMAN

AGGGGHHHHH!!!!-

ZOMBIE MAN

And uh, maybe we can pick up sometime later.

ZOMBIE MAN exits and ZOMBIE WOMAN continues eating. Scene shifts to EMILY.

EMILY

CHAPTER 15- Entertaining Zombies. Polite conversation used to be a dinner party starter. But in these times it is best to being with food, then move into conversation. Serving live food is always a great way to show respect to your guests, but be cautious because humans are cunning and quick, and could leave you in an embarrassing situation.

Scene shifts. ZOMBIE HOSTESS and her 3 ZOMBIE GUESTS sit around a table that is draped in a cloth, whimpers can be herd.

ZOMBIE HOSTESS

I've prepared a male tonight. I hope that's okay?

ZOMBIE HOSTESS removes the cloth to reveal a man strapped down to a table. He begins squirming and crying.

HUMAN

No. No, please, please, no.

ZOMBIE GUEST 1

Fantastic!

ZOMBIE HOSTESS

Shall we?

HUMAN

Please, please don't eat me.

ZOMBIE HOSTESS & GUESTS

ARGGHHHHAAAA!!!!

HUMAN

Noooooooo.....

ZOMBIE HOSTESS

Look at him squirm.

ZOMBIE GUEST 2

I know. It's so cute.

The ZOMBIES turn their attention away from the table long enough for the man to get loose and quietly escape.

ZOMBIE GUEST 3

You know, I find the men have far more developed muscles, and when you take that first bite the blood just sprays right out, dousing you in a sweet and succulent sauce.

ZOMBIE HOSTESS

That blood, it might be my favorite part of the whole meal. To be honest, I might prefer it to the brains.

ZOMBIE GUEST 3

Careful there, you're almost starting to sound like a vampire.

ZOMBIE HOSTESS

(*laughing*) We all know vampires aren't real. (*Looks back at the table*) Oh!- Uh....

ZOMBIE GUEST 1

Where did he go?

ZOMBIE HOSTESS

I'm not sure. I thought I had him down tight. I've got some day-old brains in the fridge I can pull out.

ZOMBIE GUEST 2

I'm on a special diet, only eating fresh food.

ZOMBIE HOSTESS

I never intended for our little gathering here to turn into a hunt, but he can't be that far. If we start now, we can probably chase him down.

Scene shifts to EMILY.

EMILY

Chapter 20- Zombie Family Life. At the dawn of this new age the definition of family drastically changed. While some still choose to keep a semblance of the traditional family, with a mother, a father and 2.5 children, others choose to live in herds. Family sizes, structure, and complexity are varied. And since adding to the family does not occur by procreation, but rather by transformation, everyone's family appears different. But with all the diversity today's families present, we all still share the same basic values of inclusion, acceptance, and the common goal of self-preservation.

Scene shifts, ZOMBIE GIRL is holding the hand of BILL, he is petrified as they stand before ZOMBIE MOM and ZOMBIE DAD.

ZOMBIE GIRL

Mom, Dad, I want you to meet Bill, my boyfriend.

ZOMBIE MOM & ZOMBIE DAD

Aaarrrgghhhh!!!

ZOMBIE GIRL

Stop, you're scaring him.

BILL

Please don't eat me. Please!

ZOMBIE MOM

You brought home a human. How could you?

ZOMBIE GIRL

I love him!

ZOMBIE MOM

Oh, you love him? Is it for his brains or for his body, tell me that!

ZOMBIE GIRL

Both mom, both. He's really great if you just give him a chance.

ZOMBIE DAD

Do you remember your brother? Huh? No. That's right! He brought home a female, and she ended up chopping off his head. We're lucky we escaped.

ZOMBIE GIRL

But Bill isn't like that. Are you Bill?

ZOMBIE DAD

(*To Bill*) Are you?! (*Aggressively*) Arrrggghhh!!!

BILL

No. No. I'm not like that. I have no inappropriate intensions with your daughter. Sir.

ZOMBIE DAD

Then what are your intensions?

BILL

Nothing. I just- She just brought me here. Said it was safe.

ZOMBIE GIRL

It is safe. Right mom? Right dad?

ZOMBIE MOM

Of course, honey. (*To ZOMBIE DAD*) He looks strong.

ZOMBIE DAD

Muscular.

ZOMBIE MOM

Fast.

ZOMBIE DAD

Smart.

ZOMBIE MOM

Agile.

ZOMBIE MAN

That could come in handy.

ZOMBIE GIRL

Mom? Dad? What are you talking about?

ZOMBIE DAD

Honey, you've done great.

ZOMBIE MOM

He's going to make a nice addition to the family.

ZOMBIE DAD

Ever since your brother lost his head, I've wanted another boy around.

ZOMBIE MOM & ZOMBIE DAD

(*They lunge towards BILL*) AAARRRGGGHHHH!!!!!

ZOMBIE GIRL

No! I like him the way he is!

ZOMBIE MOM and DAD take down BILL. ZOMBIE GIRL begins crying.

Please stop! Mom! Dad! No! He was so soft and so warm.

ZOMBIE DAD

You had to know this was going to happen.

ZOMBIE GIRL

But I just thought we could be different, you know. I know, I know, call me a dreamer or possibly even a radical peace maker.

ZOMBIE DAD

Not in this family.

ZOMBIE GIRL

I guess not. (*Beat*) Not the face mom!

ZOMBIE MOM

Well dear, we can't all be perfect. Don't worry, he's going to fit in just fine.

Scene shifts to EMILY.

EMILY

My dear reader, thank you for trusting not just my advice, but considering me as your companion and guide. And remember, while self-preservation is of the utmost importance in these trying times, politeness and manners never go out of style.

THE END